Strengthening Romania's Bioinformatics Infrastructure: CRB's FAIR Initiatives

ELIXIR Romania (Observer)

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CRB structure

- established in 2022
- co-founded by 17 universities and research centers, RSMG and **RSBI**

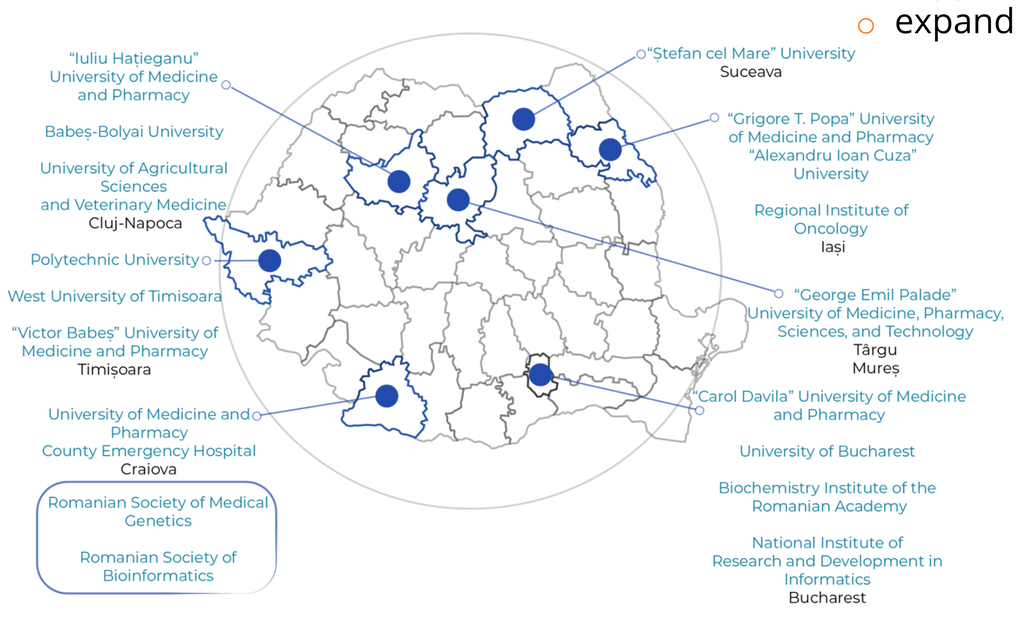
Mission

Advance Romanian Bioinformatics by:

- enhancing data value
- improving access to tools and resources
- supporting training initiatives
- expanding computing infrastructure

ELIXIR involvement

- Romania became an ELIXIR Observer in 2023
- CRB aims to become the official ELIXIR Node
- CRB is involved in ELIXIR-STEERS WP4: strengthening and equipping ELIXIR Nodes and Node staff with key skills and resources in organisation, management, and training



2019-2020
Early attempts bypassing ELIXIR

2022
CRB founded with commitment to ELIXIR interoperability

October 2023
ELIXIR Romania's Observership

April 2024
ELIXIR Membership request

Current projects

Evaluate training FAIRification options in Romania

At the start of 2025, CRB conducted a national consultation to assess:

- **e-learning practices**
- **the interest in a centralized training platform**
- **the awareness of ELIXIR resources**

222 responses were collected, including 54 from the life sciences sector.

E-learning platform need

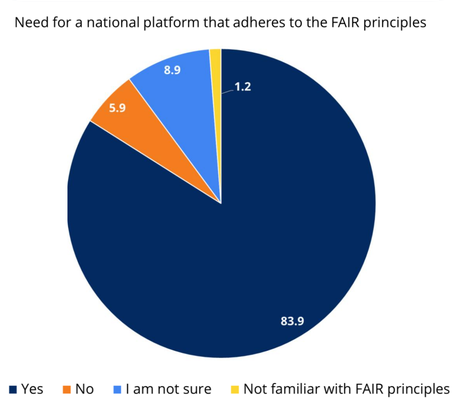
84%

Most e-learning platforms in Romania are limited to internal use within universities.
83% of respondents support the creation of a national platform.

E-learning platforms

TeSS	3.7%
Galaxy Training	24%

Although 24% of life sciences respondents were familiar with Galaxy Training, only 3.7% knew of TeSS, highlighting the need for better outreach.



Contribution recognition

80%

A necessity for the recognition of contributors to open-access resources was revealed, emphasizing the need for policy improvements to ensure proper acknowledgment of their efforts.

Develop a peer-reviewed registry of national bioinformatics tools

To support the Romanian ecosystem, the Catalogue of Romanian Bioinformatic Services (CaRoBioS) aims to:

- Promote the awareness of services developed by RO research groups
- Increase the domestic and European use of services developed by RO research groups
- Provide structured feedback according to a set of review criteria aligned to the FAIR principles
- Identify critical aspects of interoperability to improve existing services
- Facilitate access to funding to ensure the sustainability of key services

Steps for joining the CaRoBioS

1. Submission of a form with information about the service
2. A peer-review evaluation, based on criteria aligned to the FAIR principles
3. Inclusion in the CaRoBioS, based on the review committee recommendations
4. Communication of the recommendations to the service's contact person
5. Classification as an ELIXIR RO Service

CRB is a partner in ELIXIR-STEERS, WP4: Enhancing the capabilities of ELIXIR Nodes and their staff through improved organisation, management, and training. The activities carried out in this project were supported with funding from ELIXIR-STEERS.

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/RomanianBioinformaticsCluster

CRB FEDERATED BIOINFORMATICS IN ROMANIA

ELIXIR ALL HANDS 2025